
PAPERBOY

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Brent went through \$100 after strikes on Saudi energy infrastructure, two days before a US inflation print that was already about energy.

AI

OpenAI says an unreleased model proved half of a Millennium Prize problem

WHAT HAPPENED

OpenAI [published on 8 September](#) that an unreleased system, described as "significantly more capable than GPT-6 Astra" and set on the problem from 28 August, found a proof of finite-time blowup for the 3D incompressible Navier-Stokes equations: an initially smooth fluid at rest developing a singularity in finite time. That settles statements C and D of the Clay Institute's formulation, the negative half. The proof was found on 5 September and formalised in Lean by GPT-6 Astra in 17 hours. OpenAI says it does not intend to claim the prize, and credits concurrent independent work on the related forced-Euler problem by Levent Alpoge and Tristan Buckmaster. No peer review has happened yet.

WHAT IT MEANS

A frontier lab claiming an open research result rather than a benchmark score is new. The Lean formalisation is the part that matters: it makes the claim mechanically checkable instead of a press release. OpenAI's decision not to claim the prize leaves the burden of proof where it belongs, which is the right instinct and also a hedge.

WATCH NEXT

Independent replay of the Lean proof; acceptance by the fluid-dynamics community.

Stolen session tokens are draining Claude subscribers' usage

WHAT HAPPENED

Anthropic confirmed to [TechCrunch on 8 September](#) that "a bad actor is using common infostealer malware to steal Claude login sessions from people's computers, then using those login sessions to access Claude accounts and consume their usage." A UK-based consultant, Grant De Swardt, first noticed his quota climbing from 45% to 55% with no activity of his own on 4 August; Anthropic determined that "a compromised Claude session key was used to mint unauthorized Claude Code OAuth tokens." Other users on Reddit and GitHub reported accounts pinned at their daily limit for days. Anthropic has signed affected users out, invalidated authorisations and issued partial refunds.

WHAT IT MEANS

The attack does not touch the model. It steals a credential off an ordinary laptop and spends someone else's metered compute, which makes AI subscriptions worth stealing the way cloud keys became worth stealing. The fix will be shorter sessions and device binding, and users will feel it.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Anthropic publishes an incident write-up, and whether the same technique shows up against other metered AI accounts.

OpenAI's CFO puts numbers on the cost flywheel

WHAT HAPPENED

Sarah Friar published [an essay on 8 September](#) arguing that scale and an owned stack compound into cheaper capability. The figures: over a billion weekly active users and 2.5 million businesses; OpenAI's own research organisation using "3.1 agent-workdays of effort for every workday of human labor"; GPT-5.6 Sol cutting serving costs 20%; and the in-house Jalapeno inference chip, built with Broadcom, claimed at 1.5-1.9x peak token throughput per watt against competitors. All of it is OpenAI's own accounting, unaudited.

WHAT IT MEANS

This is a financing document in essay form, published while Anthropic's prospectus is pending and OpenAI is signing multi-billion compute deals. The 3.1 agent-workdays figure is the one to distrust and the one everyone will quote.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any of the Jalapeno throughput claims get third-party benchmarking.

Micron closes above \$1,000 as the memory trade keeps running

WHAT HAPPENED

Micron [closed at \\$1,000.26 on 8 September](#), down 1.61% on the day but up roughly 256% year to date. The move sits on forecasts published in late August rather than anything new: Susquehanna put DRAM contract prices up more than 50% this quarter and NAND up 60%, and Gartner projected memory revenue nearly quadrupling to \$837.3bn in 2026. Separately, Samsung Electronics led Mistral's 3bn euro round the same day (see Startups) - a memory maker taking equity in a model lab rather than only selling into one.

WHAT IT MEANS

The thesis that memory, not logic, is the binding constraint on AI buildout is now priced at a level that needs confirming rather than repeating. Samsung writing an equity cheque into a customer is the more interesting datapoint: it reads as securing demand, and it is the kind of thing that happens near the top of a cycle as often as near the start of one.

WATCH NEXT

Micron's fiscal Q1 on 30 September, September DRAM contract settlements, and SK Hynix's Q3 margin against 76% in Q2.

Tokyo protests China's silane duties; TSMC's August revenue is still missing

WHAT HAPPENED

Japan's government has formally objected to China's provisional anti-dumping deposits on Japanese dichlorosilane, imposed at company-specific rates of 80.8% to 99.2% from 8 September, and says it is studying the impact on Japanese firms; Shin-Etsu Chemical is at 99.2% and Denal Silane at 80.8%. Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara's response reaches us only as reported speech, so we are not quoting it. Meanwhile [TSMC's monthly revenue table](#) still stops at July (NT\$467,580m, +44.7% year on year) as of Wednesday morning; the August figure normally posts within the first ten days of the month.

WHAT IT MEANS

The duty targets a consumable rather than a tool, so it bites in weeks, not years - which is the whole point of choosing it. Japan's options are narrow and slow. TSMC's August print is the cleanest single read on whether AI orders held through the summer.

WATCH NEXT

TSMC's August revenue, due imminently. Any METI countermeasure, and whether Shin-Etsu quantifies its exposure.

Brent goes through \$100 after strikes on Saudi energy infrastructure

WHAT HAPPENED

Brent crude [traded above \\$100 on 9 September](#), around \$100.9 intraday, after about \$97.9 the day before. The move followed attacks on Saudi energy infrastructure on 8 September that the Houthis claimed as their own, naming Abha, Najran and Jazan; Saudi Arabia's energy ministry confirmed fires and containment work without naming facilities. The claim that Riyadh "halted some energy operations" comes from trade coverage and is not sourced to an Aramco or government statement we could reach - treat it as unconfirmed. No independent attribution of the attacks exists; the Houthi account is a party describing its own operation.

WHAT IT MEANS

Triple-digit Brent lands two days before US CPI and a week before the FOMC, into an inflation print that was already energy-driven. It also lands eight weeks before the midterms, where the pump price is the only macro number most voters actually read.

WATCH NEXT

US CPI on 10 September. Whether Aramco says anything specific about damage or throughput.

GameStop posts a record Q2 operating profit on collectibles

WHAT HAPPENED

For the 13 weeks to 1 August, GameStop [reported on 8 September](#) net sales of \$790.2m, down from \$972.2m a year earlier, but operating income of \$160.2m against \$66.4m - its best second quarter ever - and net income of \$298.7m, or \$0.51 diluted. Adjusted diluted EPS was \$0.27. Collectibles grew 57% to \$356.3m and are now 45.1% of sales, the largest category. SG&A fell to \$187.1m from \$218.8m. The company holds \$5.4bn of liquid assets plus about 43.4 million eBay shares worth \$4.9bn, and raised full-year adjusted EBITDA guidance to "in excess of \$650 million."

WHAT IT MEANS

Sales down, profit up, and the profit is increasingly not from selling games. This is a company converting a retail footprint into a collectibles business while a balance sheet built on meme-era equity issuance earns the interest. It works until the collectibles cycle turns.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the eBay stake gets monetised, and Q3 in early December.

China's producer prices are rising again

WHAT HAPPENED

China's August CPI came in at [0.8% year on year on 9 September](#), up from 0.5% in July and in line with forecasts, while PPI rose 3.8% from 3.5%. We could not read the National Bureau of Statistics release directly - its English site returned an empty shell - so these are the NBS figures as carried by state media rather than fetched from the primary. Asian equities were soft on the day: the Nikkei closed down roughly 0.2%, the Hang Seng about 0.1% lower.

WHAT IT MEANS

A third straight month of accelerating producer prices is the clearest sign yet that China's deflation is ending, which matters more for the rest of the world than the consumer number does. Cheaper Chinese goods have been absorbing part of the tariff shock in US import prices; that cushion is thinning.

WATCH NEXT

September PPI in mid-October, and whether it starts showing up in US import price data.

STARTUPS

Mistral raises 3bn euros at 21bn, led by Samsung

WHAT HAPPENED

Mistral AI [announced on 8 September](#) a 3bn euro Series D at a post-money valuation of "more than 21bn euros," led by Samsung Electronics with EQT's Scaleup Europe Fund and existing investor PSG Equity as co-leads. Advent, BlackRock and the Luxembourg state joined; a16z, Nvidia and Salesforce Ventures were already in. Mistral calls it "the largest equity fundraising round ever completed by a European technology company" - that superlative is Mistral's own, quoted from its announcement. Proceeds are earmarked for 1 GW of European compute capacity by 2030. Macron framed the deal as France and South Korea building a third way in AI.

WHAT IT MEANS

Sovereign AI has stopped being a slogan and become a balance-sheet item. The lead investor is a Korean chipmaker, not a European fund, which tells you where the scarce input actually sits - and slightly undercuts the sovereignty framing. Roughly doubling the valuation without a released frontier model to justify it is the part that will look either early or silly.

WATCH NEXT

Where the 1 GW is sited, and whether the EU treats this as a template or a one-off.

Oura's S-1 shows the economics; the price range still does not

WHAT HAPPENED

Oura's S-1, filed 3 September, remains without an S-1/A price range as of Wednesday. The filing shows \$1.21bn of revenue in the nine months to 30 June, up 74% year on year, after \$907.9m in FY2025, up 123%. Paid members doubled to 5.0 million and trailing-twelve-month ring sales hit 3.6 million, with gross margin up to 55%. The \$924.3m net loss attributable to common stockholders is mostly a \$985m preferred-stock deemed dividend, not operations. Bloomberg has reported a raise of up to \$3bn at more than \$16bn, which Oura declined to comment on and which we have not confirmed elsewhere. The ticker will be OURA.

WHAT IT MEANS

A hardware subscription business growing 74% with 55% gross margins is a genuine test of whether the IPO window is open for something other than an AI infrastructure story.

WATCH NEXT

The S-1/A with a price range - that is the real signal, and it is overdue.

Two mid-size rounds, single-source

WHAT HAPPENED

AlleyWatch's daily tracker reports Forus, a healthtech AI company founded in 2023, raising a \$150m Series C led by Bain Capital Ventures with Thrive, General Catalyst, Accel and Redpoint, taking total funding past \$300m; and Blee, an AI legaltech platform, raising a \$20m Series A co-led by Fin Capital and SMBC's Fin Atlas Beyond Fund with Y Combinator and National Bank of Canada participating, for \$27m raised in total. Neither round appeared in a second outlet we could reach, so both are unconfirmed.

WHAT IT MEANS

Flagged rather than dropped because the shape is informative: applied-AI companies in regulated verticals are still clearing large rounds while general-purpose tooling is not.

WATCH NEXT

Company confirmations or an SEC Form D.

Kavanaugh refuses to revive Missouri's 2025 congressional map

WHAT HAPPENED

On 8 September the [Supreme Court's docket](#) in *Hoskins v. Von Glahn* records: "Application (26A304) denied by Justice Kavanaugh." Missouri Secretary of State Denny Hoskins was the applicant, with Solicitor General Louis J. Capozzi III as counsel of record and Attorney General Catherine Hanaway on the brief; they had sought a stay of a Missouri Supreme Court injunction. The effect is that the 2022 congressional map, not the 2025 Republican-drawn one that would have dismantled a Kansas City Democratic seat, governs the November election. Voters separately decide Proposition A on whether to adopt the 2025 map permanently. Missouri's AG office said it is "disappointed by this ruling, and are evaluating next steps."

WHAT IT MEANS

One seat, decided by a single Justice in-chambers with no noted dissent and no referral to the full Court - which is itself a signal about how weak the application was thought to be. The mid-decade redistricting arms race now has a loss on the board for the side that started it.

WATCH NEXT

Proposition A on 3 November, and whether other states pause their own mid-decade attempts.

Trump hands energy secretaries independent Defense Production Act authority

WHAT HAPPENED

The White House published [an executive order on 8 September](#) amending EO 13603 to give the Secretaries of the Interior and of Energy independent Defense Production Act authority over energy matters, routing disputes to the National Energy Dominance Council, or to the NSC and the Department of War where defence is implicated. The same day brought an order on accelerating access to veterans' benefits and employment, and five proclamations modifying or excluding Canadian autos, alcohol and dairy from existing tariff actions, framed as a response to "continued discrimination against the commerce of the United States."

WHAT IT MEANS

The DPA is the government's blunt instrument for compelling production and allocation, and it has been used for everything from ventilators to transformers. Splitting that authority out to energy departments, with a policy council rather than the NSC as referee, makes it easier to invoke for pipelines, grid equipment and critical minerals. With Brent above \$100, the timing is not accidental.

WATCH NEXT

The first actual DPA determination under the new delegation. Canada's response to the proclamations.

WORLD POLITICS

Trump and Putin talk for an hour after the envoys' visits

WHAT HAPPENED

Trump and Putin spoke by phone for about an hour on 8 September, according to Kremlin aide Yury Ushakov, who [called the call "constructive and quite frank"](#) and said Putin gave "an objective and thorough analysis" of the war and discussed "prospective battlefield advances." Ushakov said the two exchanged views on the Witkoff and Kushner visits and cited "very good, worthwhile ideas," and that Putin stressed Russia has "no aggressive plans regarding Europe." Every word of this is the Russian readout; the White House offered no comment. Russia's characterisation of its own campaign is not independently verified.

WHAT IT MEANS

The asymmetry from last week persists: the Moscow leg produces detail and quotes, the American side produces silence. A readout only one party gives is a negotiating position, not a record of what was said.

WATCH NEXT

Any US readout at all. Whether "worthwhile ideas" turns into a document.

Kyiv's toll rises to five dead; Ukraine moves on a 1,000-Patriot order

WHAT HAPPENED

Mayor Vitali Klitschko's updated count for Monday's strikes across five Kyiv districts is five killed and 30 injured, up from the two-to-three killed and 10 injured reported on the day; earlier wire figures ranged as high as 35 injured, so the number is still settling. The [Kyiv Independent](#) reports Ukraine will sign contracts for roughly 1,000 Patriot missiles backed by an EU loan, with Germany confirming readiness to supply launchers. Overnight into Wednesday, Ukrainian drones reportedly struck an oil terminal at Novorossiysk; damage is unconfirmed. Zelensky met Norway's Jonas Gahr Store in Oslo early Wednesday on air defence and winter preparation.

WHAT IT MEANS

Nobody has declared the three-day pause over, but a 1,000-missile interceptor order is not what a government buys when it expects a settlement. Striking Novorossiysk while Brent is above \$100 is a deliberate choice about which lever actually moves Moscow.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the Patriot contracts are signed and by whom financed. Russian confirmation of Novorossiysk damage.

Britain bans settlement goods; Israel moves to close its Jerusalem consulate

WHAT HAPPENED

UK Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband announced an import ban on West Bank settlement goods in the Commons on 8 September. Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Sa'ar [called it "outrageous lies" and "morally distorted"](#) and announced the closure of the British consulate in Jerusalem. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio declined to follow: "Obviously, we're not going to do what the UK did... I don't have any comment on it right now." Separately, an Emirati source told the Times of Israel that Mohammed bin Zayed warned Netanyahu of a coming Hamas attack days before 7 October 2023; Netanyahu's office said "no warning was given." Single-source.

WHAT IT MEANS

The consulate in Jerusalem is the UK's channel to the Palestinian Authority, so closing it is a real cost, not a gesture. Rubio's line matters more than Miliband's: it confirms the transatlantic split on settlements is now explicit.

WATCH NEXT

Whether other European states copy the ban. The Iran Panel of Experts mandate expires 27 September.

SOURCES

OpenAI - An AI model proposes a solution to a Millennium Prize problem

OpenAI - The Work Now Within Reach (Sarah Friar)

TechCrunch - Hackers are stealing Claude tokens from subscribers

Mistral AI - Series D announcement

TechCrunch - Mistral raises 3bn euros as sovereign AI becomes big business

GameStop - Second Quarter 2026 Results

Micron (MU) share price

TSMC - Monthly revenue 2026

Trading Economics - Brent crude

World Oil - Saudi Arabia halts energy operations after Houthi attacks

People's Daily - China August CPI and PPI

Supreme Court - Docket 26A304, Hoskins v. Von Glahn

White House - Adjusting Certain Delegations Under the Defense Production Act

Al Jazeera - Trump and Putin hold frank phone call

Kyiv Independent

Times of Israel - UK announces trade ban with settlements

Security Council Report - Iran, September 2026 forecast

Berlin - 2026 elections information